

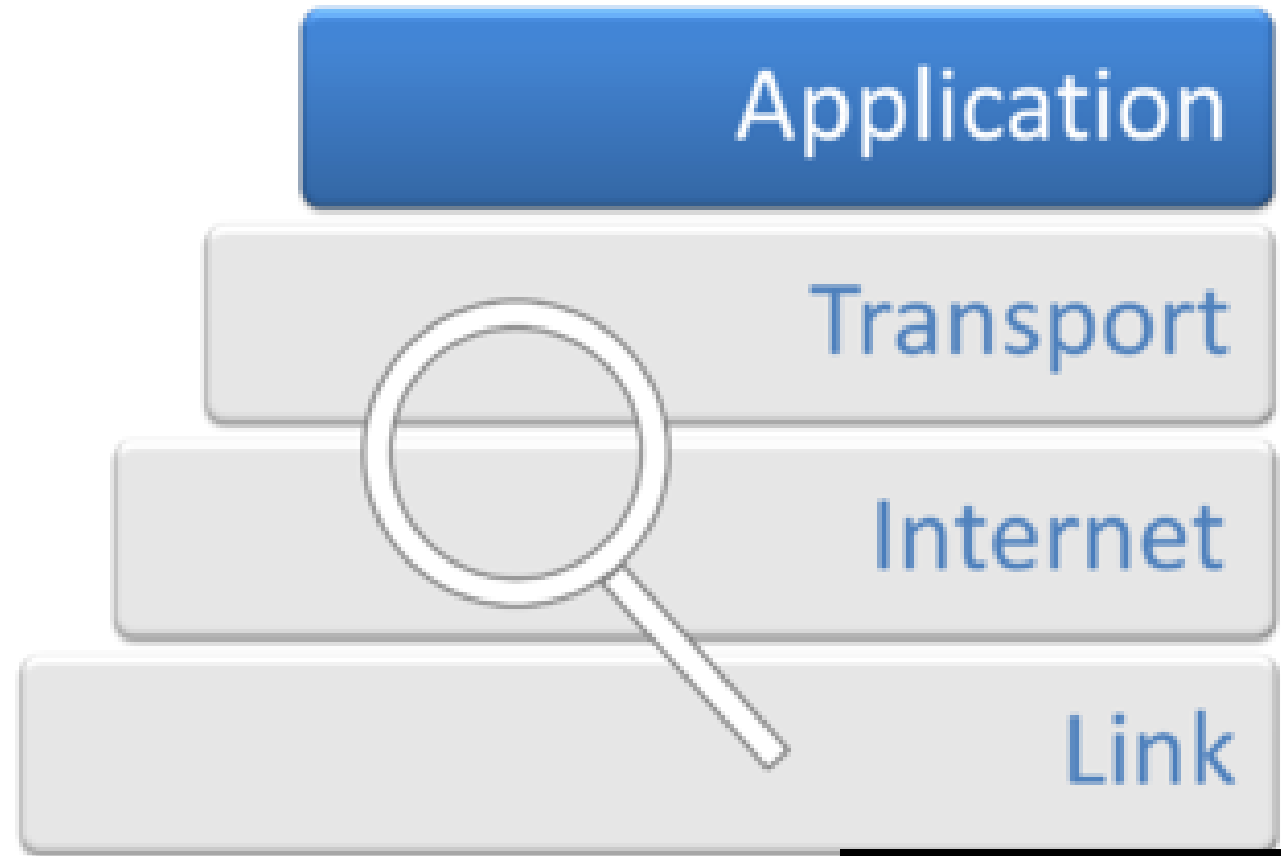
Application Layer: HTTP

Frank Walsh

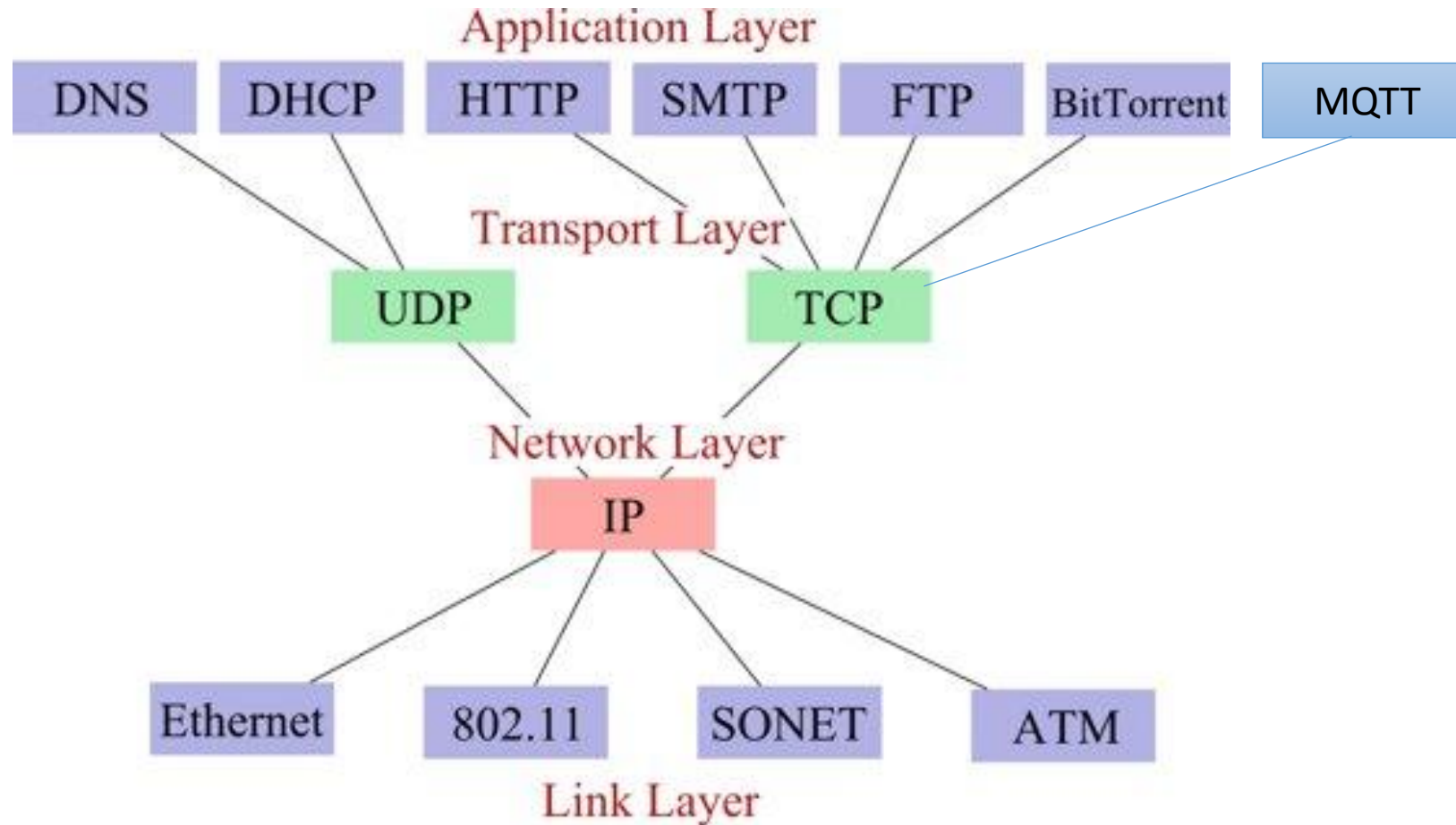


Application Layer

- The application layer provides the interfaces and protocols needed by users/applications to access the network
 - It facilitates the users/network-based applications to use the services of the network.
 - Provides services/protocols that support user authentication, naming network devices, formatting messages, and e-mails, transfer of files etc.



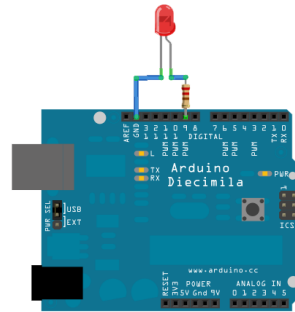
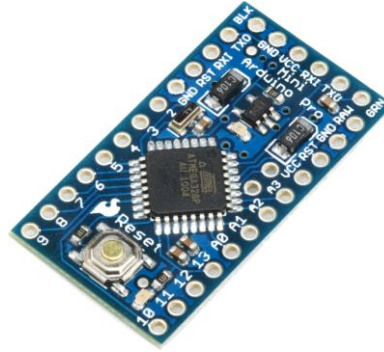
TCP/IP Protocol Stack



Web APIs

- Programmatic interface exposed via the web
- Uses open standards typically with request-response messaging.
 - Messages in well known format(e.g. JSON)
 - HTTP as transport
 - URLs
- Example would be Restful web service
- Typical use:
 - Expose application functionality via the web
 - Machine to machine communication
 - Distributed systems





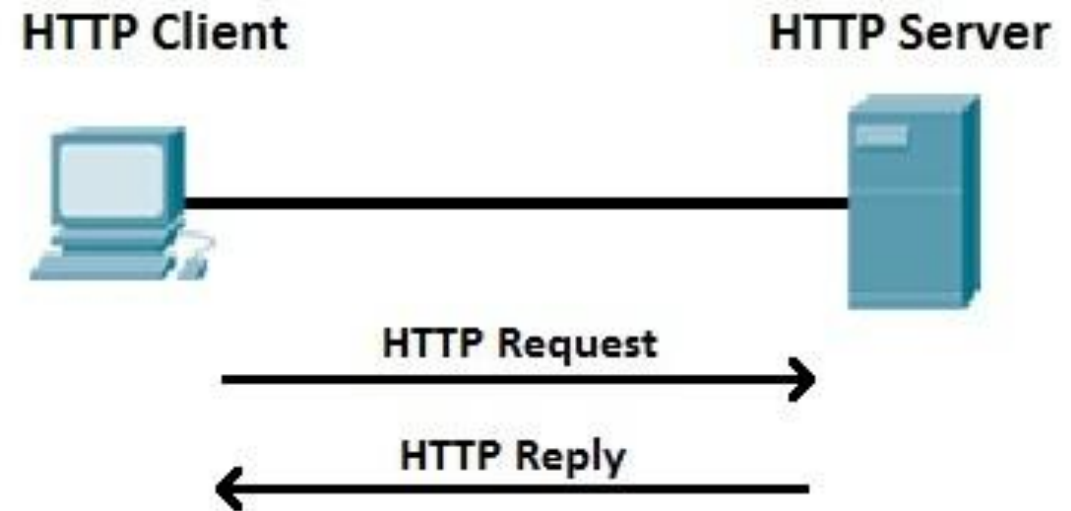
What's a Web API

- Typically implements HTTP
 - processes HTTP requests
- Usually runs on machine connected to a network
 - Has an IP address
- Serves up resources
 - Ideally in a "restful" manner
- Many different types of devices can run a web API...



What's HTTP

- HyperText Transfer Protocol
- Protocol used in World Wide Web
 - <http://www.setu.ie>
- Your browser communicates using HTTP (HTTP Client)
- Devices communicate using HTTP
- Simple, ubiquitous.



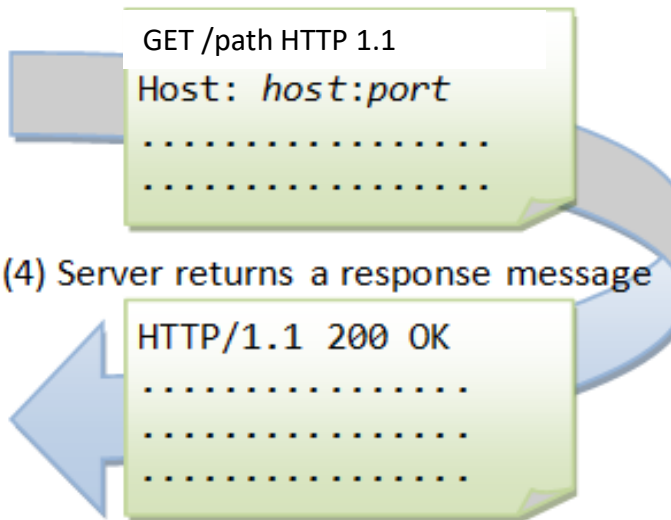
HTTP request from an application.

- (1) **URL** used to create HTTP request
`http://host:port/path/to/resource`



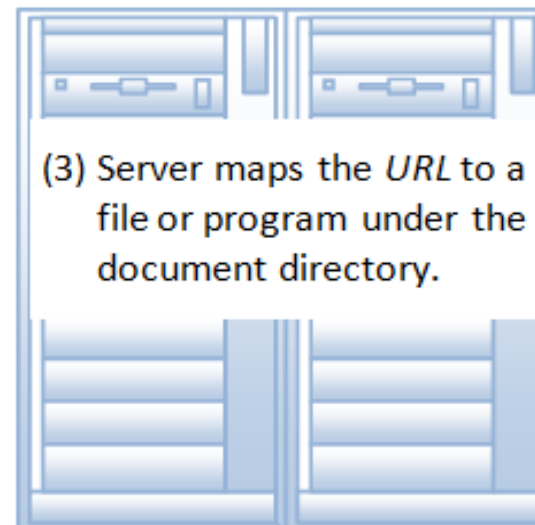
- (5) App processes response

- (2) App sends a request message



- (4) Server returns a response message

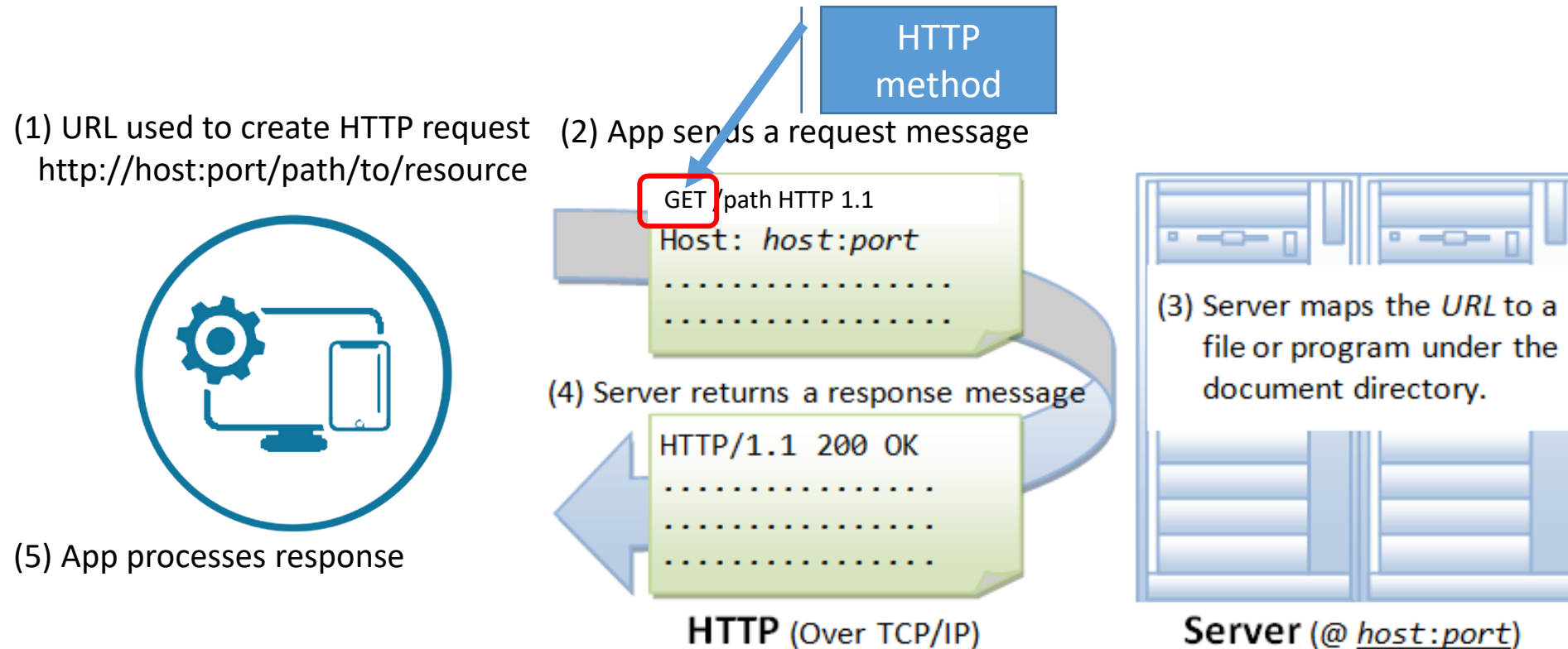
HTTP (Over TCP/IP)



- (3) Server maps the *URL* to a file or program under the document directory.

Server (@ host:port)

HTTP: The Method/Verb



HTTP: The URL

- A URL (Uniform Resource Locator) uniquely identifies a resource over the web.
protocol://hostname:port/path
- There are 4 parts in a URL:
 - **Protocol:** The application-level protocol used by the client and server, e.g., HTTP, FTP, and telnet.
 - **Hostname:** The domain name (e.g., www.nowhere123.com) or IP address (e.g., 192.128.1.2) of the server.
 - **Port:** The TCP port number that the server is listening for incoming requests from the clients.
 - **Path-and-file-name:** The name and location of the requested resource, under the server document base directory.
- Example, for <http://www.nowhere123.com/docs/index.html>
 - the communication protocol is HTTP
 - the host is www.nowhere123.com.
 - The port number was not specified, and takes default number, which is TCP port 80 for HTTP.
 - The path for the resource to be located is "/docs/index.html".

HTTP: The Request

- HTTP clients (e.g. a browser or Python module) translates a URL into a request message according to the specified protocol; and sends the request message to the server.
- For example, the client translated the URL <http://www.nowhere123.com/doc/index.html> into the following request message:

```
GET /docs/index.html HTTP/1.1
Host: www.nowhere123.com
Accept: image/gif, image/jpeg, */*
Accept-Language: en-us
Accept-Encoding: gzip, deflate
User-Agent: Mozilla/4.0 (compatible; MSIE 6.0; Windows NT 5.1)
(blank line)
```

HTTP: The Response

- When this request message reaches the server, the server can take either one of these actions:
 1. The server interprets the request received, maps the request into a file under the server's document directory, and returns the file requested to the client.
 2. The server interprets the request received, maps the request into a program kept in the server, executes the program, and returns the output of the program to the client.
 3. The request cannot be satisfied, the server returns an error message.

An example of the HTTP response message is below:

HTTP/1.1 200 OK

Date: Sun, 18 Oct 2009 08:56:53 GMT

Server: Apache/2.2.14 (Win32)

Last-Modified: Sat, 20 Nov 2004 07:16:26 GMT

Content-Length: 44

Connection: close

Content-Type: text/html

`<html><body><h1>It works!</h1></body></html>`

HTTP Protocol: Content-Type Header

- The Content-Type tells the client what the content type of the returned content.
- Also known as “MIME” ,”media type”, "content type")
 - a video file might be **audio/mpeg**, or an image file **image/png**).
- The Internet Assigned Numbers Authority (IANA) is the official authority for the standardization and publication of these classifications.



HTTP: The URL Query String

- Query string used to include data in a URL. For example

<https://www.myhome.com/heating?key=jkfgjsdkdfhg>



Query
String

- The server can use the query string to execute logic associated with that resource. For example, check if the key is valid
- Remember OpenWeather API...

HTTP Methods ("typical uses")

GET

- Request resource without sending data

PUT

- Modify/replace resource with data that you are sending

POST

- Create new resource with data that you are sending

DELETE

- Delete resource without sending data

HTTP: The Body

- An optional *body* containing data associated with the message.
- **For a HTTP request, the body can contain:**
 - content of an HTML form
 - **commands for a device**
- **For a HTTP response, the body can be:**
 - data associated with a response.
- The presence of the body and its format is specified by the start-line and HTTP headers.

cURL - Client for URLs

- A command-line tool for transferring data using HTTP, HTTPS, and many other protocols.
 - Lets you talk directly to web APIs or servers.
 - Works from any terminal - no browser required.
 - Great for testing IoT devices, REST APIs, and web services.
 - Send GET, POST, PUT, DELETE requests.
- Example:



```
curl https://api.example.com/devices
```


cURL Options

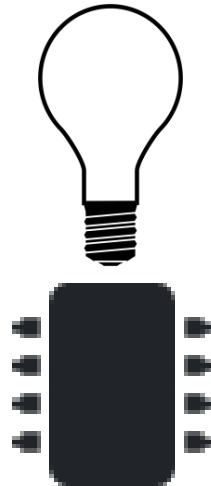
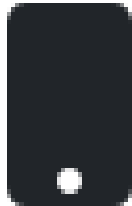
Option	Meaning	Example
-X	Specify method (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE)	-X PUT
-H	Add HTTP header	-H "Content-Type: application/json"
-d	Send data in the request body	-d '{"state": "on"}'
-i	Show response headers	-i
-v	Verbose output (debug)	-v
-o	Save output to file	-o result.json

Example:

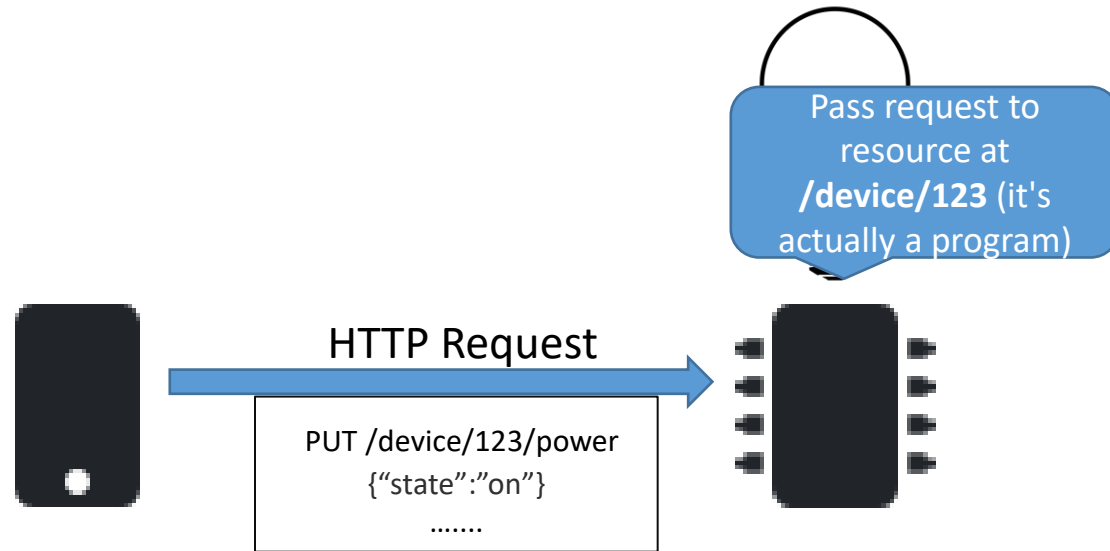
```
curl -X PUT https://api.example.com/light/1  
-H "Content-Type: application/json" -d '{"state": "off"}'
```

HTTP API for IOT Example

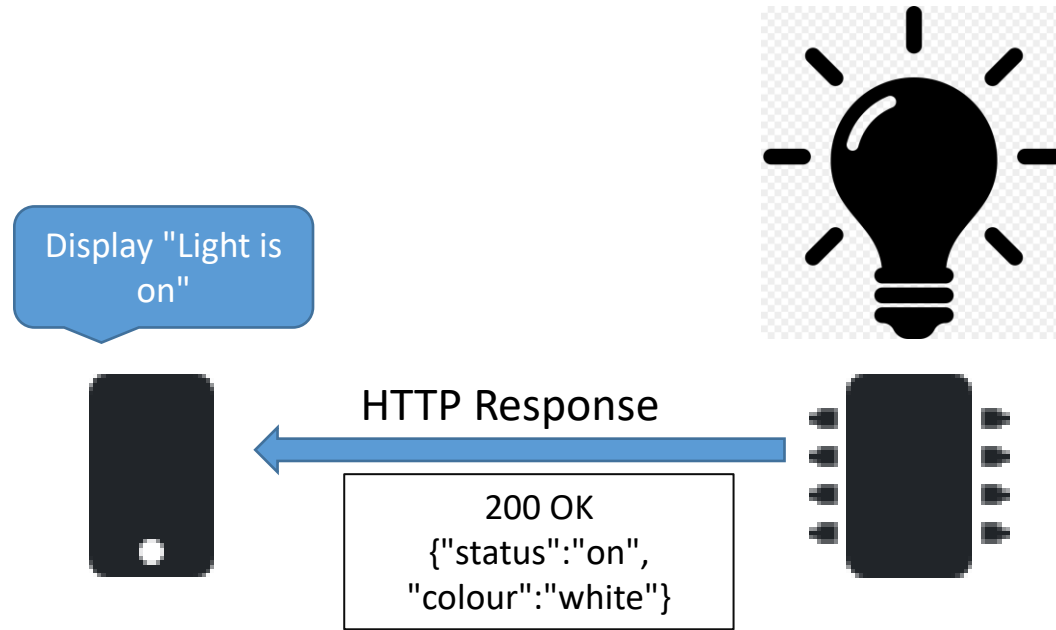
PUT {"state": "on"} to
the resource at
/device/123/power



HTTP Post



HTTP Post



External Data Representations

XML

- eXtensible Markup Language(XML)
- Same heritage as HTML(but XML is NOT HTML)
- XML data items are tagged with 'markup' strings
 - used to describe the logical structure of the data
- XML has many uses. For now we confine ourselves to external data representations
- Has many cool features including
 - Extensible
 - Textual
 - Kind of human readable and machine readable...

XML

namespace

```
<person id="123456789">
```

```
    <name>Smith</name>
```

```
    <place>London</place>
```

```
    <year>1984</year>
```

```
    <!-- a comment -->
```

```
</person >
```

```
<person pers:id="123456789" xmlns:pers =  
    "http://www.cdk5.net/person">
```

```
    <pers:name> Smith </pers:name>
```

```
    <pers:place> London </pers:place >
```

```
    <pers:year> 1984 </pers:year>
```

```
</person>
```

- Above shows XML definitions of the Person structure.
 - As with xHTML, tags enclose character data.
 - Tags : <name>, <place>, <year> data: "Smith", "London"...
- Namespaces provide a means for scoping names

JSON

- JavaScript Object Notation
- Lightweight text-based open standard designed for human readable data interchange.
- Can represent simple data structures and associative arrays.
- Good for serializing and transmitting structured data across a network

```
{  
    "id": "example",  
    "current_value": "500",  
    "at": "2013-05-06T00:30:45.694188Z",  
    "max_value": "500.0",  
    "min_value": "333.0",  
    "version": "1.0.0"  
}
```

JSON

- JSON is a data interchange format technique
- A collection of name/value pairs.
- Application programming interfaces(APIs) exist for most programming languages

```
{  
  "person": {  
    "id": "123456789",  
    "name": "Smith",  
    "place": "London",  
    "year": "1984"  
  }  
}
```

```
{ "temperature" : 72.55 }
```


HTTPS

- HTTP is not a secure protocol
 - HTTPS (Secure HTTP) should be used for internet communications
- Components:
 - HTTP
 - SSL/TLS: Secure Sockets Layer (SSL) or Transport Layer Security (TLS) encrypts the data between the client and server
- Features:
 - **Data Encryption:** Protects sensitive information from being intercepted
 - **Authentication:** Verifies the identity of websites, preventing “man-in-the-middle” attacks



HTTP in Python

- Flask

- Flask is a lightweight web framework for Python
- Simple and flexible for web development
- Simple and flexible for web development
- Good for beginners and for building small to medium-sized web applications/APIs



Flask Hello World

```
from flask import Flask

app = Flask(__name__)

@app.route('/')
def hello():
    return "Hello, World!"
```

- **Explanation:**

- `app = Flask(__name__)`: Initializes a new Flask application.
- `@app.route('/')`: Defines a route for the home page (/) and binds it to the `hello` function.